

Fixing Comma Splices — 9th Grade (25 min)

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Slides — 6 slides · 12 min · 9th Grade · Grammar & Mechanics

1. Fixing Comma Splices · 2 min

One rule. Three fixes. Five seconds.

Notes: Do not explain the title yet. Let the hook on the board do the work. Move to slide 2 only after you have heard two or three student guesses about what is wrong with the spliced sentence.

2. The rule · 1 min

A comma alone cannot hold two complete sentences together. You need something stronger.

Notes: Say this once, plainly. Then ask: 'What does stronger mean here?' Draw out: a period, a semicolon, or a comma with a conjunction. Write those three options on the board — they stay up for the whole mini-lesson.

3. The Cover Test · 2 min

- Cover everything AFTER the comma. Complete sentence?
- Cover everything BEFORE the comma. Complete sentence?
- Both yes? You have a splice. Fix it.

Notes: Walk through this slowly with the hook sentence still on the board. Cover 'she still felt unprepared' — yes, complete. Cover 'She studied all night for the exam' — yes, complete. So it is a splice. Now they have a test they can run themselves.

4. Fix 1 vs. Fix 2 · 2 min

Conjunction — The album dropped at midnight, and fans crashed the servers.

The coach called a timeout, but the players were exhausted.

Semicolon — The coach called a timeout; the players were exhausted.

Use this when the ideas are closely linked and need no extra word.

Notes: Point out that 'and' and 'but' do different jobs — 'and' adds, 'but' contrasts. Ask students which conjunction fits the album example and why. Then show the semicolon: it is a period that leans forward. No conjunction needed.

5. Fix 3 — and when to use it · 1 min

Splice — I finished my essay early, I decided to revise it one more time.

Period — I finished my essay early. I decided to revise it one more time.

Sometimes two sentences just want to be two sentences.

Notes: Ask: 'Why might a writer choose a period over a semicolon here?' Listen for: the ideas are sequential but not tightly linked. Reinforce that all three fixes are correct — the choice is about meaning and rhythm, not just grammar.

6. Exit ticket — open Yawp before you go · 4 min

Show what you know: identify the splice, name what makes it one, and fix it two ways.

Notes: Direct students to open the exit ticket in Yawp. Do not restate the question — it is already there. Collect the Diagnose & Repair handout as they leave or have them leave it on the desk.